

THE LAST FOG

Written by

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(Test script for breakdown tool)

FADE IN:

EXT. CITY PLAZA - NIGHT

A thick mist hangs low over the cobblestones of CITY PLAZA, a grand public square ringed by art-deco buildings. It is 1947. The streets glisten with the remnants of a downpour. Gas-lamp halos flicker through the haze.

A dozen BYSTANDERS in period overcoats hurry past, collars raised against the damp. Hundreds more fill the plaza behind them, barely visible through the fog.

DETECTIVE MARLOWE (50s, rumpled fedora, unlit cigarette) stands at the center of it all, staring up at the neon sign of the ATLAS HOTEL.

MARLOWE

(to himself)

Somebody always leaves the light on.

A GERMAN SHEPHERD trots to Marlowe's side, sits, and looks up at him.

MARLOWE

Not you, Rex. You never leave the light on.

INT. ATLAS HOTEL BAR - CONTINUOUS

The bar is a shrine to the 1940s -- mahogany paneling, velvet stools, a rotary phone on the counter. Behind the bar, a massive LED WALL cycles through a projected city skyline, anachronistically modern.

VERA (30s, red dress, sharp eyes) sits at the end of the bar. She watches Marlowe enter.

VERA
You're late.

MARLOWE
Traffic.

Marlowe picks up the rotary phone on the counter. Dials. No answer. Sets it down.

A WAITER sets down two glasses. Behind them, catering trays are stacked near the service door.

EXT. ATLAS HOTEL ROOFTOP - NIGHT

A DRONE SHOT sweeps over the rooftop, revealing the full scale of the city below -- thousands of lights stretching to the horizon.

THE ASSASSIN (masked, athletic) sprints across the rooftop and LAUNCHES himself off the edge -- a three-story free fall, arms spread.

He SLAMS onto the canvas awning of the hotel entrance below, rolls, and disappears into the crowd. Passersby scatter.

MARLOWE

(into radio)

He's in the plaza. All units move.

EXT. CITY STREETS - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS

A BLACK SEDAN tears around the corner, fishtailing on the wet cobblestones. Marlowe's POLICE CRUISER roars in pursuit, siren wailing.

The two vehicles race through narrow 1940s-dressed streets -- a full car chase through practical locations. The sedan clips a fire hydrant, sending a GEYSER of water into the air.

The assassin leans from the sedan window and FIRES a pistol. Marlowe ducks as the windshield SHATTERS.

The sedan takes a hard turn and EXPLODES through a fruit stand before screeching to a halt at the end of a dead-end alley.

EXT. DEAD-END ALLEY - CONTINUOUS

Marlowe skids to a stop. Gets out. The assassin stands at the far end, back to the wall.

Suddenly -- an EXPLOSION tears through the wall behind the assassin. Brick and debris rain down. A safety officer's radio crackles in the b.g.

Snow begins to fall -- thick, artificial-looking flakes that dust the alley in white. Frost creeps along the gutters.

Marlowe raises his revolver. The assassin does the same.

MARLOWE

It ends here.

A long beat. The snow falls.

SMASH CUT TO BLACK.

FADE OUT.